

My Juicy Tabbouleh

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

My tabbouleh is all about the herbs: parsley and mint chopped extremely finely, with just a little fine bulgur and a light touch of spring onion.

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INGREDIENTS

- A generous quantity of flat-leaf parsley, extremely finely chopped
- Fresh mint leaves, extremely finely chopped
- A small quantity of spring onions, very finely chopped
- Extra-virgin olive oil, for resting the spring onions and dressing the tabbouleh
- A very small quantity of fine bulgur
- Fresh lemon juice, for soaking the bulgur and adjusting the dressing
- Ripe, juicy tomatoes, extremely finely chopped, with their juices
- Pomegranate seeds
- Finely grated lemon zest
- Pomegranate molasses
- Salt, to taste

TO SERVE

- Lettuce leaves *(optional)*
- Cabbage leaves *(optional)*
- Vine leaves *(optional)*

METHOD

1. Place the fine bulgur in a small bowl and add enough fresh lemon juice to moisten it thoroughly. Leave to soak for about 1 hour, until softened.
2. Place the finely chopped spring onions in a separate bowl with a little olive oil. Set aside while you prepare the remaining ingredients, allowing their flavour to mellow.
3. Wash the parsley and mint, then dry thoroughly. Chop both extremely finely, taking your time to achieve a delicate, even texture.
4. Chop the tomatoes extremely finely, keeping their juices. Collect the pomegranate seeds and finely grate the lemon zest.
5. Place the parsley, mint and tomatoes, together with their juices, in a large bowl. Add the softened bulgur, spring onions and their olive oil, pomegranate seeds and lemon zest.
6. Add olive oil, pomegranate molasses and salt. Mix thoroughly, then taste and add more lemon juice as needed. The tabbouleh should be juicy, fresh and tangy, with a gentle sweetness from the pomegranate.
7. Cover and refrigerate for at least 1 hour before serving, allowing the herbs to soften slightly and the flavours to blend.
8. Toss again before serving and taste once more, adjusting the lemon juice, olive oil or salt if needed. Serve with lettuce, cabbage or vine leaves on the side.

Tip

Keep the bulgur to a minimum. The parsley and mint should remain the heart of the salad.

Watch Nell make it